

Application Creation, Deployment, and Management in Microsoft Configuration Manager

Introduction

Application management is a critical function in modern enterprise IT environments. Organizations require efficient tools to deploy, monitor, update, and manage software across thousands of devices. Microsoft Configuration Manager (Current Branch) provides a comprehensive framework for managing applications throughout their lifecycle. It enables administrators to create applications, define deployment types, configure detection methods, set requirements, manage dependencies, deploy applications to users or devices, and maintain them effectively over time. This essay explains in detail the complete lifecycle of application management in Configuration Manager, including creation, deployment, configuration, and ongoing management.

Concept of Application and Deployment Type

In Configuration Manager, an **Application** represents the metadata of a software program. It includes details such as the application name, publisher, software version, administrative comments, and categories. However, the application itself does not contain installation instructions directly.

A **Deployment Type** defines how the application is installed on client devices. It contains the installation files, installation commands, detection methods, requirements, dependencies, and user experience settings. Multiple deployment types allow administrators to support different installation methods or device types within a single application. For example, one deployment type may be used for Windows 10 devices, while another may support Windows 11.

The separation of application metadata and deployment logic makes Configuration Manager flexible and scalable for enterprise environments.

Methods of Creating Applications

Configuration Manager provides three primary methods to create applications:

1. Automatically Detect Application Information

This method simplifies application creation by reading installation files such as MSI packages. When an administrator selects the automatic detection option and provides the

installation file location, Configuration Manager extracts relevant information such as product name, version, and installation commands.

This method is ideal for simple applications that do not require complex configurations. It creates a basic application with a single deployment type. After creation, administrators can modify the application by adding requirements, dependencies, or additional deployment types.

2. Manually Specify Application Information

The manual method provides greater control and flexibility. Administrators manually enter application metadata such as name, publisher, version, and description. They also configure Software Center settings, including localized names, user categories, documentation links, privacy URLs, and icons.

This method is suitable for complex enterprise applications that require multiple deployment types, advanced detection methods, or custom requirements.

3. Import an Application

Applications can be exported as compressed files and later imported into the same or another Configuration Manager environment. This feature is useful for backup purposes or transferring applications between environments.

Creating and Configuring Deployment Types

After creating an application, at least one deployment type must be configured. Deployment types can be automatically identified from installation files or manually specified.

Content Configuration

The Content section defines:

- Content location (source path)
- Installation program
- Uninstall program
- Repair program
- Client cache settings

The system account of the site server must have access to the content location. Administrators can choose to persist content in the client cache to support updates or repairs.

Detection Methods

Detection methods determine whether the application is already installed on a device. They are critical because they prevent unnecessary reinstallation and help Configuration Manager track deployment compliance.

There are four main detection methods:

1. **File System Detection** – Checks for the existence of a file or folder.
2. **Registry Detection** – Verifies the presence of a registry key or value.
3. **Windows Installer Detection** – Uses MSI product codes.
4. **Custom Script Detection** – Uses PowerShell, VBScript, or JScript.

When using scripts, the exit code and output determine the detection result. A zero exit code with output indicates the application is installed, while a non-zero exit code results in an unknown detection state.

Detection methods can be grouped to create complex logical conditions.

User Experience Settings

User Experience settings control how installations behave on client devices. Administrators define:

- Installation behavior (Install for user or system)
- Logon requirements
- Installation program visibility (Hidden, Normal, Minimized, Maximized)
- Maximum allowed run time
- Estimated installation time
- Restart behavior

These settings ensure that software installation aligns with organizational policies and minimizes disruption to end users.

Requirements and Dependencies

Requirements

Requirements define the conditions that must be met before installation. Examples include:

- Operating system version
- Memory or disk space
- Device type
- Custom global conditions

Requirements help target deployments more precisely and avoid installation failures on unsupported devices.

Dependencies

Dependencies specify other applications that must be installed first. Configuration Manager supports dependency chains up to five levels deep. If configured, dependent applications are installed automatically before the primary application.

Return Codes

Return codes define how Configuration Manager interprets installer exit codes. By default, common return codes are predefined for MSI, script installers, and app packages. Administrators can add custom return codes, such as treating a non-zero code as a success.

Return codes determine whether the installation succeeded, failed, requires a reboot, or should retry later. Proper configuration ensures accurate deployment reporting.

Deploying Applications

After creating and configuring an application, it can be deployed to a user or device collection.

Deployment Settings

Administrators select:

- Action (Install or Uninstall)
- Purpose (Available or Required)

Available deployments allow users to install the application from Software Center. Required deployments automatically install the application according to a defined schedule.

Scheduling

Scheduling defines when the application becomes available and, for required deployments, the installation deadline. Administrators can configure grace periods to delay enforcement after deadlines.

User Notifications

Administrators control whether users receive notifications, whether installations are hidden, and how system restarts are handled.

Simulated deployments can test applicability without installing the application, which reduces deployment risks.

Managing Applications

Configuration Manager provides various management features:

- **Retire** – Makes the application unavailable for deployment.
- **Reinstate** – Restores a retired application.

- **Export/Import** – Transfers applications between environments.
- **Copy** – Creates a duplicate application.
- **Delete** – Removes applications (after removing dependencies and deployments).
- **Revise and Supersede** – Manage application updates.
- **Distribute Content** – Sends application content to distribution points.
- **View Relationships** – Displays dependency and supersedence diagrams.
- **Simulate Deployment** – Tests deployment conditions without installation.

Deployment types can also be prioritized, updated, copied, or deleted if no dependencies exist.

Operating System Deployment Process in Configuration Manager.

Operating System Deployment (OSD) in Configuration Manager is a structured process that allows administrators to install, upgrade, or replace Windows operating systems on computers in an organization. The deployment process involves several essential steps.

First, administrators must identify the required Windows device drivers needed to start the boot image and install the operating system image. Drivers ensure that hardware components such as network adapters and storage devices function properly during deployment.

Next, a suitable boot image must be selected. A boot image is based on Windows Preinstallation Environment (Windows PE) and is used to start the destination computer before installing the full operating system.

After selecting the boot image, an operating system image must be prepared. This image can either be captured from a reference computer using a task sequence or selected from a default operating system image in Windows Imaging Format (WIM).

The boot image, operating system image, and related content such as drivers and applications are then distributed to distribution points so that client computers can access them.

A task sequence is created to define the step-by-step deployment process. This includes partitioning disks, applying the OS image, installing drivers, restoring user data, and installing applications.

The task sequence is deployed to a collection of computers. Finally, administrators monitor the deployment process using Configuration Manager's monitoring tools to ensure successful installation.

Operating System Deployment Scenarios in Configuration Manager.

Configuration Manager provides several deployment scenarios depending on organizational needs.

Upgrade Windows to the Latest Version:

This scenario upgrades an existing Windows version to a newer version while keeping applications, settings, and user data intact. It is faster and more resilient than traditional wipe-and-load methods.

Refresh an Existing Computer (Wipe and Load):

In this scenario, the existing computer is formatted and a new version of Windows is installed. User settings and data can be migrated after installation using USMT.

Install a New Version on a New Computer (Bare Metal):

This involves installing Windows on a new computer that does not have an operating system installed. It is a clean installation without previous data.

Replace an Existing Computer:

This scenario installs Windows on a new computer and transfers user settings and data from an old computer to the new one.

Each scenario is designed to meet different business requirements and hardware conditions.

Methods Used to Deploy Operating Systems.

Configuration Manager supports multiple deployment methods:

PXE-Initiated Deployment:

Client computers boot from the network using Preboot Execution Environment (PXE). The boot image and OS image are sent from a PXE-enabled distribution point.

Software Center Deployment:

The OS is made available in Software Center, and users can initiate installation manually.

Multicast Deployment:

This method sends OS data simultaneously to multiple computers, conserving network bandwidth.

Bootable Media Deployment:

Deployment is initiated using bootable media such as USB or DVD. The content is downloaded from the network during installation.

Stand-Alone Media Deployment:

All required content is included in the media. It is useful in environments with no or limited network connectivity.

Pre-Staged Media Deployment:

A WIM file is pre-installed on the computer. The computer later connects to Configuration Manager to complete the deployment.

Each method is suitable for different network environments and organizational needs.

Role of Windows ADK in OS Deployment.

The Windows Assessment and Deployment Kit (ADK) is a set of tools required for OS deployment in Configuration Manager.

It supports tasks such as installing Windows, capturing images, and migrating user profiles. Important components include:

- **Windows PE:** Used for boot images.
- **User State Migration Tool (USMT):** Used to capture and restore user data.
- **Windows Deployment Tools:** Used to customize and deploy Windows images.

The Windows ADK must be installed on site servers and SMS Providers before installing Configuration Manager. It is an essential external dependency for successful OS deployment.

How User State is Saved and Restored During OS Deployment.

User state migration ensures that user data and settings are preserved during OS deployment. Configuration Manager uses the User State Migration Tool (USMT) within task sequences.

User data can be stored in three ways:

State Migration Point:

User data is stored remotely on another server. After OS installation, the data is restored from the migration point.

Local Storage:

User data is temporarily stored on the same computer and restored after deployment.

Hard Links:

Data remains on the local drive even after the old OS is removed. The new OS reconnects to the existing files without copying them, making the process faster and reducing network traffic.

This process ensures minimal data loss and smooth transition for users.

Infrastructure Requirements for OS Deployment.

OS deployment requires both external and internal infrastructure components.

External Dependencies:

- Windows ADK (with Windows PE and USMT)
- Windows Deployment Services (WDS) for PXE
- DHCP server for PXE boot
- DNS server
- IIS for distribution and management points
- WSUS for installing updates during deployment

Configuration Manager Dependencies:

- Management Point
- Distribution Point (PXE or multicast-enabled if needed)
- State Migration Point
- Reporting Services Point
- Driver Catalog
- OS Image (WIM format)

Proper configuration of these components ensures smooth deployment operations.

Endpoint Protection in Configuration Manager

Introduction

Endpoint Protection in Configuration Manager is a centralized security solution used to protect organizational computers from malware, spyware, rootkits, and advanced network-based attacks. It enables administrators to manage security policies, monitor threats, and respond quickly to incidents from a single console. By integrating with Windows Defender and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, it provides comprehensive protection across client computers and servers in an enterprise environment.

Key Features of Endpoint Protection

1. **Antimalware and Real-Time Protection**
 - o Detects and removes viruses, spyware, trojans, and rootkits.
 - o Real-time protection prevents malicious software from installing or executing.
 - o Supports scheduled scans such as daily quick scans and weekly full scans.
 - o Provides automatic remediation of infected files.
 2. **Automatic Definition and Engine Updates**
 - o Uses Configuration Manager software updates to distribute the latest malware definitions.
 - o Ensures protection against newly discovered threats.
 - o Can download updates from Microsoft Update if systems are outside the corporate network.
 - o Keeps the protection engine updated for better detection and performance.
 3. **Network Inspection System (NIS)**
 - o Protects against network-based exploits targeting system vulnerabilities.
 - o Reduces the time gap between vulnerability discovery and patch deployment.
 - o Works with real-time protection to block suspicious network traffic.
 4. **Cloud-Based Protection Service**
 - o Reports unknown threats to Microsoft Malware Protection Center.
 - o Quickly downloads updated definitions when new malware is identified.
 - o Enhances detection accuracy through global threat intelligence.
 5. **Windows Defender Integration**
 - o Built into Windows 10 and Windows Server 2016 and later versions.
 - o Automatically managed when the Configuration Manager client is installed.
 - o Uses an advanced and regularly updated protection engine backed by security researchers.
-

Windows Defender Firewall Management

Endpoint Protection allows administrators to centrally manage Windows Defender Firewall settings, including:

- Enabling or disabling the firewall for different network profiles (Domain, Private, Public).
- Blocking incoming connections, including unauthorized programs.
- Notifying users when a program is blocked.

This ensures consistent firewall policies across the organization and strengthens network security.

Policy Creation and Deployment

- Administrators create **custom antimalware policies** based on organizational requirements.
- Different policies can be applied to different collections (e.g., client computers and servers).
- Scan schedules can be customized (e.g., daily quick scans for users, weekly full scans for servers).
- Phased deployment allows testing on small groups before full implementation.
- Compliance and security status are monitored through dashboards and reports.

Using custom client settings instead of default settings is recommended to avoid applying the same configuration to all systems.

Alerts, Monitoring, and Reporting

Endpoint Protection provides advanced monitoring features:

- Email alerts for malware detection.
- Alerts when infections exceed a defined threshold.
- Notifications for repeated malware incidents.
- Monitoring through the Endpoint Protection dashboard.
- Built-in reports for analyzing infection trends and compliance status.

These features help administrators quickly detect, investigate, and respond to threats.

Implementation Example (Woodgrove Bank Scenario)

In a practical implementation:

- The Endpoint Protection site role is installed at the top-level site server.
- Device collections are created for clients and servers.
- Email alerts are configured using an SMTP server.
- Definition updates are scheduled multiple times per day.

- Custom antimalware policies are deployed (daily quick scans for clients, weekly full scans for servers).
 - Windows Firewall policies are centrally managed.
 - Continuous monitoring ensures business security requirements are met.
-

Advantages of Endpoint Protection

- Centralized security management
- Improved threat detection and response
- Automated updates and remediation
- Reduced administrative effort
- Enhanced network and endpoint security

Troubleshooting SCCM server

Troubleshooting an SCCM (Microsoft Endpoint Configuration Manager) server usually involves checking site components, connectivity, logs, client communication, and the SQL-back-end layer.

1. Definition of SCCM Server Troubleshooting

SCCM server troubleshooting means identifying and resolving problems with the SCCM Site Server and its site system roles (such as Management Point, Distribution Point, Software Update Point, etc.) so that clients can discover, install agents, and receive policies, updates, and applications successfully.

Key Troubleshooting Steps:

1. Check SCCM Services

- Ensure all SCCM services are running (SMS Executive, SQL Server, IIS, etc.).
- Use **Services.msc** or Configuration Manager Service Manager.
- Restart stopped services if required.

2. Verify Site Server Health

- Check **Site Status** and **Component Status** in SCCM Console.
- Look for critical or warning errors.
- Review server resources (CPU, RAM, Disk space).

3. Review SCCM Logs

- Use central logging tools (Log Viewer, CMtrace) to examine SCCM server logs such as SmsExec.log, LocationServices.log, DpxManager.log, WSyncMgr.log for errors during sync, client discovery, or content distribution.
- On the client side, check ClientIDManagerStartup.log, MP_ClientIDRegistrationManager.log, Inventory Agent.log, and SmsAgent.log to confirm successful communication with the server.

4. SQL Server Check

- Ensure SQL Server service is running.
- Verify database connectivity.
- Check SQL logs for errors.
- Confirm sufficient database space.

5. Client-Side Troubleshooting

- Verify client installation.

- Check client health in SCCM Console.
- Restart **SMS Agent Host (ccmexec)** service.
- Reinstall client if necessary.

6. Distribution Point Issues

- Ensure content is properly distributed.
- Validate boundary groups.
- Check network connectivity between server and DP.

7. Boundary and Boundary Group Verification

- Ensure clients are assigned to correct boundary groups.
- Incorrect boundaries cause deployment failures.

8. Software Update Issues

- Check WSUS synchronization.
- Verify SUP (Software Update Point) configuration.
- Review update deployment logs.

9. Network and Firewall Check

- Verify required ports are open (HTTP/HTTPS, SQL).
- Ensure no firewall blocks communication.

10. Backup and Recovery

- Regularly verify SCCM backup status.
- Restore site if corruption occurs.

Key Uses of SCCM Troubleshooting:

- Troubleshooting covers various aspects of the infrastructure, ranging from server-side components to client-side health.
- **Patch Management:** Troubleshooting stuck updates, failed compliance reporting, and WSUS sync issues.
- **Client Health Check:** Fixing broken WMI repositories, client communication issues (certificates, HTTP/HTTPS), and repairing broken agents.
- **Software Distribution:** Resolving issues where applications fail to install or download, often requiring inspection of AppEnforce.log or CAS.log.
- **Operating System Deployment (OSD):** Diagnosing PXE boot failures, driver issues, or task sequence failures.

- **Boundary & Boundary Group Issues:** Ensuring clients map to the correct Distribution Points for content downloading.

Common Troubleshooting Techniques:

- **Log File Analysis:** Reviewing log files (.log) with CMTrace is the most common method, specifically looking at UpdatesHandler.log, AppEnforce.log, and LocationServices.log.
- **Monitoring Workspace:** Using the SCCM Console's Monitoring tab to track distribution status, software updates, and system health.
- **Support Center Tool:** Using the SCCM Support Center to collect client data and run diagnostics.
- **WMI Repair:** Repairing or resetting the Windows Management Instrumentation (WMI) repository on clients, a common cause of agent failure.
- **Boundary Validation:** Checking if boundaries and boundary groups are correctly configured.

Troubleshooting SCCM Clients

System Center Configuration Manager (SCCM) clients are small agents installed on endpoints that enable communication with the SCCM server for tasks like software deployment, patching, compliance, and inventory. When clients malfunction, troubleshooting ensures smooth IT operations.

1. Client Installation Status

- **Definition:** The SCCM client must be properly installed on endpoints to function.
- **Uses:** Enables communication with the SCCM site server.
- **Importance:** Without installation, the client cannot receive policies or updates.
- **Steps:**
 - Check SCCM Console → Devices → Client column.
 - Review ccmsetup.log for installation errors.
 - Reinstall using ccmsetup.exe if needed.

2. Site Code Assignment

- **Definition:** Site codes identify which SCCM site manages the client.
- **Uses:** Ensures the client connects to the correct management point.
- **Importance:** Wrong site code prevents communication.
- **Steps:**

- o Open Configuration Manager Properties → General tab.
- o Verify site code matches the intended SCCM site.
- o Correct via client push or manual configuration.

3. Client Logs

- **Definition:** SCCM logs record client activities and errors.
- **Uses:** Provide diagnostic information.
- **Importance:** Essential for pinpointing issues.
- **Steps:**
 - o Key logs: ccmsetup.log (installation), ClientIDManagerStartup.log (identity), LocationServices.log (site assignment).
 - o Use CMTrace tool for easier log reading.

4. Network Connectivity

- **Definition:** Client must reach SCCM servers (Management Point, Distribution Point).
- **Uses:** Enables policy retrieval and content download.
- **Importance:** Network issues cause failed deployments.
- **Steps:**
 - o Test DNS resolution (nslookup).
 - o Ping SCCM server.
 - o Check firewall rules and proxy settings.

5. Repair Client Agent

- **Definition:** Fixes corrupted or misconfigured client software.
- **Uses:** Restores functionality without full reinstall.
- **Importance:** Saves time compared to reinstallation.
- **Steps:**
 - o Control Panel → Configuration Manager → Repair.
 - o Use PowerShell (Repair-SCCMClient).
 - o Command line: ccmrepair.exe.

6. Verify Services

- **Definition:** SCCM relies on Windows services.

- **Uses:** Services like SMS Agent Host handle communication.
- **Importance:** Stopped services halt client activity.
- **Steps:**
 - Run services.msc.
 - Ensure SMS Agent Host and CCMExec are running.
 - Restart services if needed.

7. Boundaries and Discovery

- **Definition:** Boundaries define network locations SCCM manages.
- **Uses:** Ensures clients are recognized by SCCM.
- **Importance:** Clients outside boundaries won't receive policies.
- **Steps:**
 - Check SCCM Console → Administration → Boundaries.
 - Ensure client's IP/subnet is included.

8. Certificates and Authentication

- **Definition:** HTTPS-enabled SCCM requires certificates.
- **Uses:** Secure communication between client and server.
- **Importance:** Invalid certificates block communication.
- **Steps:**
 - Check client certificate validity (certmgr.msc).
 - Ensure correct PKI configuration.

9. Policy Retrieval

- **Definition:** Clients download policies from SCCM.
- **Uses:** Policies dictate software, updates, and compliance.
- **Importance:** Without policies, client is unmanaged.
- **Steps:**
 - Control Panel → Configuration Manager → Actions tab.
 - Run "Machine Policy Retrieval & Evaluation Cycle."
 - Check PolicyAgent.log for errors.

10. Client Health Monitoring

- **Definition:** SCCM provides dashboards to monitor client health.
- **Uses:** Identifies unhealthy clients proactively.
- **Importance:** Prevents widespread failures.
- **Steps:**
 - SCCM Console → Monitoring → Client Health.

Uses of SCCM Client Troubleshooting:

- **Ensures Software Deployment:** Clients must function correctly to receive applications and updates.
- **Maintains Security Compliance:** Patch management relies on healthy clients.
- **Supports Inventory Accuracy:** Hardware/software inventory data comes from clients.
- **Improves User Experience:** Reliable clients reduce downtime and IT support calls.
- **Optimizes IT Operations:** Healthy clients allow administrators to manage thousands of endpoints efficiently.

Operations and maintenance for reporting in Configuration Manager

Reporting in **Microsoft Configuration Manager (SCCM)** is built on **SQL Server Reporting Services (SSRS)** and provides administrators with insights into deployments, compliance, and client health. Once reporting is set up, ongoing operations and maintenance are essential to ensure accuracy and usability.

+-----+

| **Configuration Manager** |

| **Console (Monitoring Node)** |

+-----+-----+

|

v

+-----+

| **Reporting Services Point** |

| **(SQL Server Reporting** |

| **Services - SSRS)** |

+-----+-----+

|

v

+-----+-----+

| **Configuration Manager** |

| **Site Database (SQL DB)** |

+-----+-----+

|

v

+-----+-----+

| **Users / Admins (Browser)** |

| **Report Manager URL** |

- ✓ Reports stored in **SSRS**
- ✓ Data retrieved from **Site Database**
- ✓ Access through **Console or Web Browser**

2. Running Reports

Reports can be executed in two ways:

a) From SCCM Console

- Go to **Monitoring** → **Reporting** → **Reports**
- Select report → Click **Run**
- Provide required parameters

b) From Web Browser

- Open **Report Manager URL** (e.g., <https://Server/Reports>)
- Navigate to ConfigMgr folder
- Select and run report

🔑 Required Permissions:

- Read (Site permission)
- Run Report permission

3. Modifying and Editing Reports

Modify Properties

- Change report name & description
- Done via **Report Manager** → **Properties tab**

Edit Reports

- Use **Report Builder**
- Recommended to use **Save As (Clone)** before editing default reports
- Prevents overwrite during site upgrades

⚠ Important:

- Site updates rename modified built-in reports (adds underscore _)
- Backup custom reports before upgrades

4. Creating Reports

Two main types:



Model-Based Report SQL-Based Report

Model-Based Report

- Wizard-based creation
- No SQL knowledge required
- Uses predefined report models

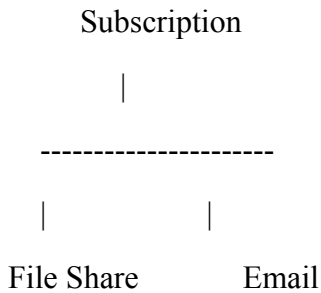
SQL-Based Report

- Custom SQL queries
- Use supported views (start with **v_**)
- Can use stored procedures (start with **sp_**)
- More flexible and powerful

- ✓ Requires Site Modify permission
- ✓ Must have Modify Report permission for folder

5. Managing Report Subscriptions

Subscriptions allow **automatic report delivery** at scheduled times.



A) File Share Delivery

- Delivered to shared folder (UNC path: \server\folder)
- Needs Write permission
- Formats: PDF, Excel, Word, CSV, XML
- Static file (no interactive features)

B) Email Delivery

- Sent as attachment or link
- Can include multiple recipients
- Requires SSRS email configuration
- Supports scheduled delivery (hourly, daily, weekly)

6.Scheduling Reports

- Use shared schedule OR create new schedule
- Define:
 - o Start date & time
 - o Frequency
 - o End date (optional)
- Allows unattended report generation

7. Favorites Feature (Version 2103+)

- Frequently used reports can be marked as ★ Favorites
- Accessible under **Favorites Node**
- User-specific (not site-wide)
- Requires SQL Server 2017+

Key Maintenance Activities:

- ✓ Monitor report server health
- ✓ Backup custom reports
- ✓ Verify permissions
- ✓ Maintain SQL performance
- ✓ Check subscription status regularly

List of reports in Configuration Manager

Configuration Manager (SCCM) provides **hundreds of built-in reports** organized into categories, helping administrators monitor and manage clients, software, and compliance

Administrative security:

The following six reports are listed under the **Administrative Security** category.

Report name	Description
Administration activity log	Displays a record of administrative changes made for administrative User security roles, security scopes, and collections.
Administrative users security assignments	Displays administrative users, their associated security roles, and the security scopes associated with each security role for each user.
Objects secured by a single security scope	Displays objects that an administrator assigned to only the specified security scope. This report doesn't display objects that an administrator associates with more than one security scope.
Security for a specific or multiple Configuration Manager objects	Displays securable objects, the security scopes associated with the objects, and which administrative users have rights to the objects.
Security roles summary	Displays security roles and the Configuration Manager administrators associated with each role.
Security scopes summary	Displays security scopes and the Configuration Manager administrative users and security groups associated with each scope.

Alerts:

The following two reports are listed under the Alerts category.

Report name	Description
Alert scorecard	Displays a summary of all postponed alerts that were generated between the specified start and finish date.
Alerts Generated Most Often	Displays a summary of the alerts that were generated most often from today back to the specified date for the specified feature area.

Asset Intelligence:

***Hardware Reports** – Show details of devices, processors, memory, and system configurations.

***Software Reports** – Provide information about installed applications, usage statistics, and software categorization.

***License Reports** – Track purchased vs. installed software, helping with compliance and audits.

***Usage Reports** – Monitor application usage frequency to identify underused or redundant software.

***Security Reports** – Highlight potentially vulnerable applications or unauthorized installations.

Client push:

The following four reports are listed under the **Client Push** category.

Report name	Description
Client push installation status details	Displays information about the client push installation process for all sites.
Client push installation status details for a specified site	Displays information about the client push installation process for a specified site.
Client push installation status summary	Displays a summary view of the client push installation status for all sites.
Client push installation status summary for a specified site	Displays a summary view of the client push installation status for a specified site.

Compliance and Settings Management:

Reports on configuration baselines and CI compliance.

Endpoint Protection:

Monitors malware infections, definition updates, and client health.

Hardware (General, Disk, Memory, etc.):

Provides detailed inventory, such as "Hardware 01A – Summary of Computers in a Specific Collection".

Software Updates (A-E):

- Covers compliance, deployment management, and scan results.

Software Distribution (App/Package):

- Monitors deployment status, content distribution, and application monitoring.

Client Status:

- Reports on agent activity and health.

Site Infrastructure:

- Includes server information, database replication, and discovery data.

Important Specific Reports:

- **Monitoring Dashboard:** Provides a high-level overview of infrastructure health.
- **Site System Status Message:** Used for troubleshooting component errors.
- **Asset Intelligence - Software 05A (Browser Helper Objects):** Identifies BHOs installed on computers.
- **Hardware - Disk 01 (Computers with low free disk space):** Identifies systems with limited storage.